

DELUSIONS

1. INT. BEDROOM- EVENING

Shekhar enters the bedroom with a pale face and hugs his wife, Shefali. Shikha, their daughter was standing there and frowning with anger.

SHEKHAR (CRYING FACE)

I don't know what to say. I am speechless my love. Can't help with my tears today.

SHEFALI

I know dear. It's hard.

SHIKHA (ANGRY) TO SHEFALI

I am amazed that you are still not getting it.

SHEFALI

Shut up! Learn to behave with elders. You Genz's are sometimes intolerable.

SHIKHA

And you millenials behave only as tolerables.

SHEKHAR

I know I haven't loved her and given her enough time and I am the only culprit for this.

SHIKHA

You loved none of us either. Better not to lie.

SHEFALI

Shut Up! Behave and leave the room. You idiot.

SHEFALI

Dear, Please don't be stressed out because of her.

SHEKHAR

No, Babe our daughter is just hot tempered. I know she'll be fine in sometime.

SHEFALI

Hope so.

2. INT.SHIKHA'S ROOM-NIGHT

Shefali came running into her room frustrated and angrily.

SHEFALI

What's the problem with you stupid.
When everything is getting worse, why
are becoming a hurdle in between and
making it more worse?

SHIKHA

What do you mean I am becoming a
hurdle in between my own parents?

SHEFALI (SLAPPING HER)

You won't let us live. We all are
living on your father's money. He has
done a lot for you. Be grateful.

SHIKHA

Fine. I just want you to be okay.

3. INT. HOSPITAL-DAY

Doctor steps in the room. Shefali and Shekhar are sitting and
trying to figure out Shefali's Petscan report.

DOCTOR

Good morning! Mr. & Mrs. Garg.

SHEFALI AND SHEKHAR

Good morning doctor.

DOCTOR

I have examined the petscan reports.
I know that last time I told you that
a polyp is found in her stomach and
it might be cancerous, but today I
have to tell you that it is.

Shefali burst into tears. Shekhar could not stop crying as
well.

DOCTOR(HESITATINGLY)

After a few more tests. We'll be able
to tell you the stage. Till then you
need to keep hope and have faith in
us. We'll try our best.

4. INT. HOME- NOON

Phone rings in the hall and Shikha's younger sister, Shaina runs
to pick it up, while Shikha is studying in her bedroom.

NEERAJ (SHEFALI'S BROTHER)

Hello.

SHAINA

Hello. Who's this?

NEERAJ

Your uncle dear. Hand over the phone
to your didi.

SHAINA

Yeah! She's studying but...wait. Didi,
Uncle wanna talk to you.

SHIKHA

Yupp! Coming.

NEERAJ

Do it fast.

SHAINA

Just a minute.

SHIKHA

Yes mamu. What happened? How's Mum?

Now Neeraj narrates her the whole thing that doctor said.

NEERAJ

I am with your Mum and Dad at
hospital only. Take care of Shaina.
Bye.

SHIKHA

Hm...

Now Shikha starts crying and Shaina want to know about what exactly happened as nobody told her previously about the lat tests.

SHAINA

Didu, what happen? Why are you
crying.

SHIKHA (SOBBING)

Mum...

SHAINA

What happened to her?

Shikha tells Shaina and now both of them are in blues.

5. INT. HOSPITAL-EVENING

SHEKHAR

I love you and I can't live without
you.

SHEFALI

If I die how will our children live.

SHEKHAR

This will never happen. Stop thinking
about this. We'll go to the best
hopsital and will get best treatment.

SHEFALI

I have faith in you.

Neeraj is busy doing hospital formalities and is checking the reports and also talking to his doctor friends.

At that very moment, Shikha and Shaina enters the coridoor.

SHAINA

Mumma...

SHIKHA (CONTROLLING TEARS)

Hey Mum!

Both hug her. Shaina hugs Shekhar as well but Shikha doesnot.

SHIKHA

We'll go to the Mamu's house for your better treatment and there we'll get better environment too.

SHEFALI

What is the problem with you. I wanna stay at my home.

SHEKHAR

Are you still angry just because I didn't take out time for you from my Sunday Meeting. Why can't you be just serious for atleast your mother.

SHIKHA

I don't wanna talk about it.

SHEKHAR

These kids now-a-days will not understand the seriousness of a problem.

NEERAJ (STANDING AT A DISTANCE)

Hey, Shikha come here for while.

SHIKHA

Yes, Mamu.

NEERAJ

Don't be so aggressive just because your father didn't take you people out as he was busy that day. You're the eldest daughter if you won't understand then, who else will.

SHIKHA

Yes, Mamu.

6. INT.SHIKHA'S ROOM-NIGHT.

Shikha is busy doing her daily journal and Shaina steps in.

SHAINA

What happened today at the hospital?
Why were you so cranky at that time.
Are you in such a rage just because
father didn't take us that day.

SHIKHA

Do your work.

SHAINA

Again uffff...that eccentric behaviour
of yours. See, I am just 2 years
younger than you. But I know that
being an elder sister you're expected
to be more mature and understanding.
But don't you think so that you
inculcated a little maturity in me as
well. Atleast this much that I can
understand you better than others.
Please open up Di. I love you a lot
and can't see you in such a tension
which might be solved by
communication.

SHIKHA

It can't be solved Like this dear.
So, better leave me alone and get out
of the room.

SHAINA

This room doesn't belong only to you.
This is mine too. So you get out.

Now, both of them start fighting with pillows and other stuff
and after all that quarrel Shikha starts crying and Shaina
throws the pillow onto the bed and hugs her, trying to make her
comfortable.

SHIKHA

You know when Papa said that he's
busy on Sunday because of a meeting
and then furiously I went to his
office that day...to...

SHAINA

Yeah! I remember you said you wanna
go there but then after coming back
you said that you met your school
friend so you didn't go there.

SHIKHA

I lied.

SHAINA

Why?

SHIKHA

I went there and saw....

SHAINA

What did you see? Come on. Go on.

SHIKHA

Papa talking to Anne Aunty and both of them were going in a car somewhere.

SHAINA

So what? She works there.

SHIKHA

But there was no meeting. He was holding her hand while making her sit into the car and she was not wearing office formals.

SHAINA

No, wait... You're going on the wrong track. How can you even think of this. He's our father.

SHIKHA

That's why I wasn't telling you.

SHAINA

But tell me what you basically wanna say?

SHIKHA

Our father is a cheater and is cheating on mum since days, months and years, I don't know.

SHAINA

Shut up! This is dirty. How can you even think like that.

SHIKHA

That's why I told you not to ask.

SHAINA

See how much he loves us and mum.

SHIKHA

Now, I am almost blind. Sorry! I can't see that, it all feels like superficial.

SHAINA

Do you have any other proof or something else you know?

SHIKHA

Tell me how much time he ever spent with us since years.

(MORE)

SHIKHA (CONT'D)

He comes from office daily late at 12-1 also sometimes drunk. Leaves in the morning at 9. Now you tell me.

SHAINA

Hey! He runs a big company dude. This is normal.

SHIKHA

No, this is not. My friend's father runs a company bigger than ours but they go on vacations, spend time together and enjoy a lot.

SHAINA

How can you be so sure?

SHIKHA

Yeah, again just for the sake of surity I didn't tell anyone that day. But waited for another proof thinking I might be wrong. Then next day when Mum's report of ultrasound came, I was sad so went to terrace and Pappa was standing there, then I stood at a distance and eavsdropped and he was I am sure talking to her (refers to Anne).

SHAINA

Really, What did he say?

SHIKHA

Something you would have not expected again. Even I can never expect that he'll be that cheap. I overheard their conversation on phone. He said that he's happy that Mum got a life threatening disease and he'll pray for her death. So, he can marry Anne.

SHAINA

No, Don't say that.

SHIKHA (CRYING FACE)

What am I saying? Just truth babe.

SHAINA

If it's true, then how do we tackle this.

SHIKHA

That's the whole point. Now Mum is also not well. How to tackle this. I am very stressed out.

SHAINA

I think we should tell her.

SHIKHA

Gone mad? If I want that I would have told her. But I didn't. Don't you know how much she loves him. She won't be able to carry this stone.

SHAINA

Let's tell Mamu.

SHIKHA

Will he believe?

SHAINA

He should. Ultimately he's the only option we have.

SHIKHA

Let's wait for tomorrow, right now, it is very late.

SHAINA

Hmm...

7. INT. HOSPITAL-MORNING

Shekhar and Shefali are sitting in the room for the doctor. And waiting for reports of other tests.

SHEKHAR

Shef, See it'll be a begining stage only. You 'll get well soon.

SHEFALI

Hoping so dear.

Doctor steps in.

DOCTOR (HURRIEDLY)

Good morning. Please listen to me carefully. It's Stage 4.

SHEFALI

What???

Shefali broken down into tears.

DOCTOR

We need to start diagnosis as soon as possible.

SHEKHAR

I'll do all the formalities today itself.

Taking Shefali outside Shekhar calls Neeraj and tells him everything.

Neeraj calls Shikha and tells her all.

8. INT. SHIKHA'S ROOM-MORNING

Sadness is all around. Both the sisters crying and thinking now what to do and how will they handle both the situations.

SHAINA

Now, what will we do?

SHIKHA

I don't know. I just want my mother totally well.

SHAINA

But don't you think so that she should be aware of this.

SHIKHA

I don't think like that. Let her heal, why should we put in more pain into her veins.

9. NEXT DAY- INT. HOME

Hustle and bustle at home as all are quickly getting ready for the hospital and preparing themselves mentally. Suddenly, Shekhar's phone rings displaying as Anne. Shefali lost in her gloom can't even hear it up. Suddenly her eyes fell on the screen and she picks it up.

ANNE (ON PHONE)

Darling, You said to call at sharp 9.
I did . How's your soon dying wife?
When is she gonna die?

Shefali muted the call and shouted .

SHEFALI

Shekhar, Shekhar. Where are you?

SHEKHAR

Yes, darling coming.

SHEFALI

Who is this on phone?

SHEKHAR

Who is there babe?

SHEFALI (ANGRY)

Your Manager Anne. You are cheating on me. How dare you?

Shikha and Shaina came running into the room after listening their mother's voice.

ANNE (MUTED ON SPEAKER)

Baby where are you? Why are you not talking? Darling ...Shying before marriage.

Shefali threw the phone and was furious. Shekhar in anger that she threw that very expensive phone, slapped her face. Shikha in anger called her Mamu and narrated all the incidence also the past experiences she till then Shaina was consoling her mother.

Neeraj reached there quickly.

NEERAJ

I can never expect this behaviour from you.

SHEKHAR(EMBARRASED)

I am sorry ...I...I was angry.

NEERAJ

And what about cheating on my sisterwho took care of your family and your children in need.

SHEKHAR

I am sorry.

NEERAJ

Get ready for divorce. She's not well otherwise I would have shown you that how it feels when somebody cheats.

SHIKHA

I am ashamed to be your daughter.

SHEKHAR

I am ...

Shikha, Shaina and Neeraj hug Shefali and all of them were crying in gloom and pity. Neeraj took his nieces and sister to his house and went for check up with his sister.

10. AFTER FEW DAYS

11. INT.HOSPITAL-DAY.

Shefali is unable to breathe.

SHIKHA

Mum talk to me, please.

SHEFALI

I...I ...Just become indep...

SHAINA

Mum please.

SHIKHA

I am listening. Yes..

SHEFALI

Be independent and never forget the
morals, I taught you.

Shefali dies and tears roll down the cheeks of Shikha and
Shaina.